



NJALA UNIVERSITY

ADDRESS

By

Professor Sahr Moses Gevao

Chancellor, Njala University.

at the

2025 Congregation Ceremony

for the Conferment of Higher Degrees, Awards of Postgraduate Diplomas,

*Theme: Turning Resources into Results and Accelerating Digital Learning in
Njala University*

Venue: Forecourt of the Administrative Building, Njala Campus, Njala.

Date: Saturday 21st & 22nd February 2025

Salutations

- His Excellency the President, Commander-in-Chief of the Armed Forces of the Republic of Sierra Leone, and Visitor of Njala University
 - Hon Vice President of the Republic of Sierra Leone
 - Hon Chief Minister of the Republic of Sierra Leone
 - Minister of Technical and Higher Education
 - Other Ministers and Deputy Ministers of Government here present
 - Members of the Njala University Court
 - College Chancellors of USL, EBKUST, ETU-SL, MMTU and KUST
 - Vice- Chancellors and Principals of Public and Private Universities and other Tertiary Institutions here present.
 - Excellences, Members of the Diplomatic & Consular Corps
 - Our Revered Paramount Chiefs and other Traditional Rulers
 - Your Worships the Mayors of the cities of Bo, Bonthe, Makeni, Freetown, and Kenema.
 - Hon. Members of Parliament
 - The Chairpersons and Members of the Moyamba, Bo, Pujehun and Bonthe District Councils
 - Representatives of International Organizations and Agencies
 - Our Development Partners
 - Alumni of Njala University
 - Representatives of Civil Society Organizations
 - All Staff and Students of Njala University
 - All citizens of the Republic of Sierra Leone present here and all of you following this event remotely or otherwise
 - Members of the Fourth Estate
 - Distinguished Guests
 - Ladies and Gentlemen
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1. It's my singular honor and on behalf of Njala University Court to start this address by thanking the Government profusely for the appointment of the current management team at Njala University, starting with this esteemed University Court and the Top Administration of the University.
 2. Let me take this opportunity to welcome, most warmly, the graduands whose presence amongst us is the very reason for the celebration today; and to offer a special thank you to the parents and guardians who have joined us today to celebrate their children's achievements. Thank you all for being here today

3. **Madam Minister, Distinguished ladies and Gentlemen,** with the responsibility undertaken for consensus building, partnerships, cooperation and coordination, the University Court and the administration have maintained confidence building, stable and sustainable management among all categories of staff Associations especially the Academic Staff and students, the intervening communities, chiefdoms, and the districts of operations at large throughout the academic year. Additionally, my Governance is in very cordial working relationship with MTHE, the Administrative and Academic Staff, as well as students, and with the highest aspirations and tremendous confidence repose on us, we are continuing to make significant contributions to our anticipated transformation in effort to rebranding Njala University to global ascendancy.
4. **Madam Minister, Distinguished ladies and Gentlemen.** On assuming the responsibility as Chancellor of Njala University, I decided together with the Court, that the trust of our leadership apart from the statutory functions of Court by law should be primarily focused on the establishment of a second Medical School in our beloved country. In that vein, some processes have been completed and reported at last year's congregation like the start of the Pre-Med Programme, while others are still in the process, but much accomplishments have been made in the establishment. I am happy to inform this congregation that preferably by October this year the Towama location would be renamed as the **College of Medical Sciences**, the Fourth campus of the University, for the establishment of three Schools - Schools of Medicine, Nursing and Public Health. This proposal had gone through the statutory provisions of the University. we want to assure the nation that the implementation action in the establishment of the second Medical School in Njala will enhance and strengthen our capabilities in human capital development in the medical professional as a nation.
5. The Bachelor of Medicine and Surgery (MBCHB) Curriculum on the other hand, has long been validated and is in the final process. Comments from the reviewers had been reviewed and incorporated in the document. The document is now set for the final stage of the accreditation process by the Tertiary Education Commission (TEC).

6. We have held robust sensitization workshops in Moyamba and Bo Districts for all categories of Chiefs and medical practitioners about the establishment of a full medical school in Njala.
7. We want to thank the Ministry of Health for the support in the establishment of the NU Medical School.
8. Madam Minister, it is again a great honor to inform this congregation that:
 - a. we have refurbished the former Laision Building of the University to now serve as the Administrative Block of the Medical School.
 - b. We are at the final end of the process for the award of a contract for the construction of six (6) classrooms and Laboratories for the Medical School at Kowama Location in Bo. You may wish to take another day to visit the site.
 - c. That since lecturers in Bio-Chemistry, Physiology and Anatomy are in short supply, some sort of training at the Master's level had been recommended to be jointly developed by USL and NU. However, we are in the process of recruiting three lecturers abroad from various universities in Biochemistry, Anatomy and Physiology purely for the Medical School.
9. As a way of concluding my address, distinguished ladies and gentlemen, let me impress on your minds that the current administration of Njala University has superintended a very transparent and accountable leadership since its inception, and such reforms are fully supported by the University Court for the betterment of the University. The University's Account have been successfully audited by the External Auditors from 2019 – 2023 Financial Years. The 2024 Final Accounts have been prepared and presented as well.
10. Once more ladies and gentlemen, we thank the Government for the unwavering support and the invaluable provision towards the development of sustainable and stable higher and technical education in our beloved nation.

***THANK YOU ALL, GOD BLESS YOU AND I WISH YOU A HAPPY
CONGREGATION CEREMONY***